SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

6 September 2023 · Shift 1

47 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 43 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 1 question

Q.5

The average weight of 20 students of a class was 30.5 kg. After 6 new students joined the class, its average weight increased by 2 kg. Find the average weight of the 6 new students who joined the class (rounded off to one decimal place).

(A) 30.5 kg
(B) 32.5 kg
(C) 39.2 kg
(D) 38.5 kg

General Awareness 22 questions

Q.2

The stretch between Mumbai to Goa of western coast of India is known as _____.

(A) Coromandel coast
(B) Konkan coast
(C) Malabar Coast
(D) Kannada Plain

Q.3

Which of the following autobiographies is NOT correctly matched with the concerned cricketer?

(A) Playing it My Way – VVS Laxman
(B) The Test of My Life: From Cricket to Cancer and Back – Yuvraj Singh
(C) Straight from the Heart – Kapil Dev
(D) Cricket Delightful – Mushtaq Ali

Q.4

What does El Niño refer to?

(A) Hot water current
(B) Pressure water current
(C) High air pressure
(D) Low air pressure

Q.5

Where was the 13th Hockey India senior women’s national hockey championship held?

(A) Andhra Pradesh
(B) New Delhi
(C) Punjab
(D) Karnataka

Q.6

Which Article of the Constitution of India provides for a Council of Ministers with the Prime Minister at the head to aid and advice the President in the exercise of the President's functions?

(A) Article 77
(B) Article 74
(C) Article 71
(D) Article 72

Q.7

Which of the following is a key objective of Micro Finance Institutions in India?

(A) Providing loans exclusively to women entrepreneurs

(B) Encouraging large-scale industrialisation

(C) Maximising profits for shareholders

(D) Promoting financial inclusion and poverty alleviation

Q.8

_____ is one of the most important festivals of Kamakhya temple of Guwahati. It is held every year during the monsoon (mid-June) season, when the temple is closed for three days for tantric rites.

(A) Ambubachi

(B) Bihu

(C) Baishagu

(D) Me-Dum-Me-Phi

Q.9

In which city is the Kamakhya temple situated?

(A) Dehradun

(B) Bhopal

(C) Guwahati

(D) Indore

Q.10

Which of the following statements best defines a Micro Finance Institution (MFI)?

(A) MFIs are investment firms that cater exclusively to high-net-worth individuals.

(B) MFIs are non-profit organisations that provide financial services to low-income individuals and small businesses.

(C) MFIs are banks that provide loans only to large corporations.

(D) MFIs are government agencies that regulate the microfinance sector.

Q.11

Mumbai Indians defeated which team to win Women's Premier League in March, 2023?

(A) UP Warriors

(B) Royal Challengers

(C) Delhi Capitals

(D) Gujarat Giants

Q.12

The Songi Mukhawate dance of _____ celebrates the victory of truth over falsehood. The name of the dance is derived from the two lion masks worn by two dancers who represent Narasimha, an aspect of Lord Vishnu.

(A) Madhya Pradesh

(B) Jharkhand

(C) Maharashtra

(D) Gujarat

Q.14

Where was the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association founded in 1928?

(A) Kanpur

(B) Amritsar

(C) Lucknow

(D) Delhi

Q.15

Which process is sometimes called "reduction division" because it reduces the number of chromosomes to half the normal number to form sperm and eggs?

(A) Amitosis

(B) Meiosis

(C) Cytokinesis

(D) Karyokinesis

Q.16
Which chemical element with atomic number 35 has a dark reddish-brown liquid with a burning pungent odour?

(A) Tennessine
(B) Chlorine
(C) Astatine
(D) Bromine

Q.17
In which year did Pakistan win the Kabaddi (Circle style) World Cup?

(A) 2016
(B) 2014
(C) 2020
(D) 2013

Q.18
The North–South corridor, which is a part of the Golden Quadrilateral super highways, links which two cities of India from the following?

(A) Delhi and Chennai
(B) Leh and Chennai
(C) Jammu and Kanyakumari
(D) Srinagar and Kanyakumari

Q.19
For which community was a journal Rast Goftar started for the purpose of social-religious reforms?

(A) Sikhs
(B) Muslim
(C) Parsis
(D) Hindu

Q.20
26 January was selected as the date of the inauguration of the Constitution because on the same date in 1930, the Indian National Congress had revealed _____.

(A) Quit India Movement
(B) Purna Swaraj Movement
(C) Namak Satyagraha
(D) Khilafat Movement

Q.21
What is the name of the scheme launched by Uttar Pradesh government to boost milk production?

(A) Nand Baba Milk Mission
(B) Gokul Milk Mission
(C) Krishna Balram Milk Mission
(D) Gua Ras Mission

Q.22
What is the source of Directive Principles of State Policy?

(A) The instrument of instructions from GOI Act 1919
(B) The instrument of instructions from GOI Act 1935
(C) The instrument of instructions from GOI Act 1909
(D) The instrument of instructions from GOI Act 1947

Q.23
How many classical dance forms does the Sangeet Natak Akademi in India officially recognise, as of August 2021?

(A) 9
(B) 6
(C) 7
(D) 8

Q.24
According to the Human Development Report 2021-22, what is the rank of India among 191 countries?

(A) 117
(B) 180
(C) 148
(D) 132

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. The Indian team had its “back against the wall”, but managed to fight back.

(A) In extreme joy or exhilaration
(B) Stuck in a difficult circumstance with no escape
(C) Forced to indulge in propaganda
(D) Throwing the opposition off guard

Q.2

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. This is the first time / I ate such / a tasty cake.

(A) I ate such
(B) This is the first time
(C) No error
(D) a tasty cake

Q.3

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A lover of books

(A) Philosopher
(B) Librarian
(C) Teacher
(D) Bibliophile

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Tom waited until _____ to start working on his term paper but managed to finish it just in time.

(A) the twelfth hour
(B) the thirteenth hour
(C) the tenth hour
(D) the eleventh hour

Q.5

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Cordial

(A) Unfriendly
(B) Friendly
(C) Brave
(D) Aromatic

Q.6

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Bigger fish to fry

(A) To barely get something done
(B) Having something more important to take care of
(C) Having work more than one’s capacity
(D) To be similar to one’s parents in some way

Q.7

There is a spelling error in the given sentence. Select the option that contains the INCORRECTLY spelt word. The hungery goblin scratched the grammar book with a feather.

(A) hungery
(B) scratched
(C) feather
(D) grammar

Q.8

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The rusty door made a _____ screeching noise.

(A) low
(B) soft
(C) harsh
(D) smooth

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The tone of his voice seemed to _____ that he knew more than he was letting on.

(A) incise
(B) intent
(C) inculcate
(D) imply

Q.10

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Enormous

(A) Tiny
(B) Inapposite
(C) Irrelevant
(D) Gigantic

Q.11

There is a spelling error in the given sentence. Select the option that contains the INCORRECTLY spelt word. The questionnaire appeared to be misrably designed.

(A) designed
(B) questionnaire
(C) misrably
(D) appeared

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. COVID-19 _____ structural weaknesses in health systems worldwide and negatively impacted individuals, societies, and economies.

(A) concealed
(B) laid
(C) hit
(D) revealed

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. She “will handling” the baby as tenderly as possible.

(A) wills handle
(B) shall handles
(C) will handle
(D) will handled

Q.14

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. A old woman suddenly laughed, sounding just like an amused hen.

(A) like an amused hen
(B) sounding just
(C) A old woman
(D) suddenly laughed

Q.15

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Annoy

(A) Gratify
(B) Vex
(C) Irritate
(D) Thrill

Q.16

Four words of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains a spelling error. All life depends on a healthy planet, but the “interwoven” systems of atmosphere, oceans, “watercourses”, land, ice cover and “biosphere”, which form the natural environment, are “threatned” by human activities.

(A) interwoven
(B) threatned
(C) biosphere
(D) watercourses

Q.17

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. A storm in a teacup

(A) Much excitement over something trivial
(B) A signal for upcoming storm
(C) Easy money
(D) Suffering in silence

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Varun has to _____ his studies for the sake of his ill father.

(A) sacrifice
(B) imitate
(C) reverse
(D) applaud

Q.19

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. Vikram is very stronger than I am.

(A) very stronger
(B) I am
(C) Vikram is
(D) than

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. You are always “try with jump” over the wall.

(A) trying in jumping
(B) try to jump
(C) trying to jump
(D) tried with jump

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks. Kasturi went to the garden looking for her mother. Her dog Rex was waiting (1)____ her. Kasturi picked up a stick and threw it. Rex (2)_____ the stick and brought it back. Kasturi ran (3)___ the house. Rex chased her. Kasturi ran through the garden and Rex (4)____ her. Mother yelled at both of them. She told them to stay (5)_____ of the garden and play somewhere else. Kasturi apologised to her mother. She went for a bike ride while Rex ran next to the bike.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) with
(B) by
(C) to
(D) for

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks. Kasturi went to the garden looking for her mother. Her dog Rex was waiting (1)____ her. Kasturi picked up a stick and threw it. Rex (2)_____ the stick and brought it back. Kasturi ran (3)___ the house. Rex chased her. Kasturi ran through the garden and Rex (4)____ her. Mother yelled at both of them. She told them to stay (5)_____ of the garden and play somewhere else. Kasturi apologised to her mother. She went for a bike ride while Rex ran next to the bike.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) chases
(B) throws
(C) threw
(D) chased

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks. Kasturi went to the garden looking for her mother. Her dog Rex was waiting (1)____ her. Kasturi picked up a stick and threw it. Rex (2)_____ the stick and brought it back. Kasturi ran (3)___ the house. Rex chased her. Kasturi ran through the garden and Rex (4)____ her. Mother yelled at both of them. She told them to stay (5)_____ of the garden and play somewhere else. Kasturi apologised to her mother. She went for a bike ride while Rex ran next to the bike.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) obey
(B) listen
(C) followed
(D) came

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks. Kasturi went to the garden looking for her mother. Her dog Rex was waiting (1)____ her. Kasturi picked up a stick and threw it. Rex (2)_____ the stick and brought it back. Kasturi ran (3)___ the house. Rex chased her. Kasturi ran through the garden and Rex (4)____ her. Mother yelled at both of them. She told them to stay (5)_____ of the garden and play somewhere else. Kasturi apologised to her mother. She went for a bike ride while Rex ran next to the bike.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) of

(B) in

(C) from

(D) out

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.5 **(C)**

General Awareness

Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(D)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**
Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(B)**
Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**		

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(D)**

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.5 · Answer (C) 39.2 kg

The 20 students weigh 20 × 30.5 = 610 kg and all 26 weigh 26 × 32.5 = 845 kg, so the 6 new students weigh 235 kg: 235/6 ≈ 39.2 kg.

General Awareness

Q.2 · Answer (B) Konkan coast

The Konkan coast is the stretch of the west coast from Mumbai to Goa; the Kannada plain lies south of it, the Malabar coast further south in Kerala, and the Coromandel coast is on the east.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Playing it My Way – VVS Laxman

'Playing It My Way' is Sachin Tendulkar's autobiography; VVS Laxman's is '281 and Beyond'. The other three are matched correctly.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Hot water current

El Niño is the periodic warming of the surface waters of the central and eastern equatorial Pacific, when warm water appears off the coast of Peru in place of the cold Peru current.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Andhra Pradesh

The 13th Hockey India Senior Women National Championship was held at Kakinada, Andhra Pradesh, from 15 to 26 February 2023.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Article 74

Article 74(1) provides for a Council of Ministers with the Prime Minister at the head to aid and advise the President. Article 72 is the pardoning power, Article 71 covers disputes over the President's election and Article 77 the conduct of government business.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Promoting financial inclusion and poverty alleviation

Micro finance institutions give small loans and other financial services to low-income households that banks do not reach, to widen financial inclusion and reduce poverty.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Ambubachi

The Ambubachi Mela at Kamakhya marks the goddess's yearly menstruation: the temple stays closed for three days in June and reopens on the fourth. Bihu is Assam's seasonal festival, Baishagu the Bodo spring festival and Me-Dum-Me-Phi the Ahom festival of ancestor worship.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Guwahati

The Kamakhya temple stands on Nilachal Hill in Guwahati, Assam.

Q.10 · Answer (B) MFIs are non-profit organisations that provide financial services to low-income individuals and small businesses.

SSC's key gives the definition that MFIs provide financial services to low-income individuals and small businesses, which is their defining role. Strictly, many Indian MFIs, such as the NBFC-MFIs regulated by the RBI, are for-profit companies, but the other three options describe something else entirely.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Delhi Capitals

Mumbai Indians beat Delhi Capitals by seven wickets in the final of the first Women's Premier League at the Brabourne Stadium, Mumbai, on 26 March 2023.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Maharashtra

Songi Mukhawate is a mask dance of Maharashtra, performed on the full moon of Chaitra, in which two dancers wear Narasimha masks.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Delhi
The Hindustan Socialist Republican Association was founded at Feroz Shah Kotla in Delhi in September 1928, when Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev and other young revolutionaries met there and reorganised the Hindustan Republican Association with a socialist aim.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Meiosis
Meiosis halves the chromosome number, so each sperm or egg carries a single set and fertilisation restores the full number. Cytokinesis and karyokinesis are the division of the cytoplasm and of the nucleus.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Bromine
Bromine (atomic number 35) is a dark reddish-brown liquid at room temperature with a choking smell; its name comes from the Greek 'bromos', stench. Chlorine is 17, astatine 85 and tennessine 117.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 2020
Pakistan won the circle-style Kabaddi World Cup it hosted in February 2020, with the final at Lahore; it was Pakistan's first title, India having won every earlier edition.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Srinagar and Kanyakumari
The North–South Corridor runs from Srinagar to Kanyakumari. Strictly it is not part of the Golden Quadrilateral but, with the East–West Corridor, of the next phase of the same National Highways Development Project.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Parsis
Rast Goftar ('Truth-teller'), the Gujarati paper started in 1851 by Dadabhai Naoroji, worked for social and religious reform among the Parsis.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Purna Swaraj Movement
After its Lahore session adopted the goal of Purna Swaraj (complete independence) in December 1929, the Congress observed 26 January 1930 as Independence Day; the Constitution came into force on 26 January 1950 to mark that date.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Nand Baba Milk Mission
Uttar Pradesh's Nand Baba Milk Mission, announced in 2023, aims to raise milk production and help producers get fair prices through village dairy cooperatives.

Q.22 · Answer (B) The instrument of instructions from GOI Act 1935
B. R. Ambedkar likened the Directive Principles to the Instrument of Instructions issued to the Governor-General and the Governors under the Government of India Act, 1935; the idea of the Principles came from the Irish Constitution.

Q.23 · Answer (D) 8
The Sangeet Natak Akademi recognises eight classical dances: Bharatanatyam, Kathak, Kathakali, Kuchipudi, Manipuri, Mohiniyattam, Odissi and Sattriya. (The Ministry of Culture's list adds Chhau, making nine.)

Q.24 · Answer (D) 132
The UNDP's Human Development Report 2021-22, released in September 2022, ranked India 132nd of 191 countries.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (B) Stuck in a difficult circumstance with no escape
To have one's 'back against the wall' is to be in a difficult situation with no way out.

Q.2 · Answer (A) I ate such
'This is the first time' takes the present perfect: 'This is the first time I have eaten such a tasty cake.'

Q.3 · Answer (D) Bibliophile
A 'bibliophile' is a lover of books; a librarian looks after a library.

Q.4 · Answer (D) the eleventh hour
To do something at 'the eleventh hour' is to do it at the last possible moment.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Friendly
'Cordial' means warm and 'friendly'; 'unfriendly' is its opposite.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Having something more important to take care of
To have 'bigger fish to fry' is to have more important matters to attend to.

Q.7 · Answer (A) hungery
The correct spelling is 'hungry'.

Q.8 · Answer (C) harsh
A screech is a loud, grating sound, so the noise was 'harsh'; 'soft', 'low' and 'smooth' contradict 'screeching'.

Q.9 · Answer (D) imply
To 'imply' is to suggest without saying directly. To 'incise' is to cut and to 'inculcate' to instil, and 'intent' is not a verb.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Tiny
'Enormous' means very large; its opposite is 'tiny'. 'Gigantic' is a synonym.

Q.11 · Answer (C) misrably
The correct spelling is 'miserably'.

Q.12 · Answer (D) revealed
The pandemic 'revealed', brought to light, weaknesses that were already there; 'concealed' is the opposite, and 'laid' would need 'bare'.

Q.13 · Answer (C) will handle
'Will' takes the bare infinitive: 'She will handle the baby as tenderly as possible.'

Q.14 · Answer (C) A old woman
'Old' begins with a vowel sound, so it takes 'an': 'An old woman'.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Gratify
To 'annoy' is to irritate; its opposite is to 'gratify', to please. 'Vex' and 'irritate' are synonyms.

Q.16 · Answer (B) threatned
The correct spelling is 'threatened'.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Much excitement over something trivial
'A storm in a teacup' is a great fuss over something unimportant.

Q.18 · Answer (A) sacrifice
To 'sacrifice' his studies is to give them up for the sake of something more important, here his ill father.

Q.19 · Answer (A) very stronger
A comparative is strengthened with 'much' or 'far', not 'very': 'Vikram is much stronger than I am.'

Q.20 · Answer (C) trying to jump
'Always' with the present continuous describes a repeated habit, and 'try' takes a to-infinitive: 'You are always trying to jump over the wall.'

Q.21 · Answer (D) for
One waits 'for' someone: 'Rex was waiting for her'.

Q.22 · Answer (D) chased
Rex 'chased' the stick and brought it back: the past tense matches 'brought', and the dog runs after the stick Kasturi threw.

Q.24 · Answer (C) followed
Rex 'followed' her through the garden: the simple past matches 'ran'. 'Came' would need 'after', and 'obey' and 'listen' are not past forms.

Q.25 · Answer (D) out

To 'stay out of' a place is to keep away from it: 'stay out of the garden and play somewhere else'.

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